

took all the jobs because the one percent wanted more money, it was like the French Revolution again. All the bank owners, CEOs and rich were publicly lynched, and there was no economy left to speak of. Mexico and Canada allied and attacked the US to seize control of the nuclear arsenal. Almost all of the US military establishment migrated to the two countries, and then they had to build walls to keep the gun toting population out! They were all but forgotten now. Probably dead, or in the process of dying. I was lucky indeed!

"You're late! Hurry up!" whined APSaRA. I gritted my teeth as I dressed and left the house. The DNA analyser automatically unlocked the garage door as I approached and my car drove out. I got in, and ordered my breakfast at the drive in I usually stopped at.

This car had cost me a decade's salary. Very few people owned cars. I had saved and planned ahead. In just two more years the car would have paid for itself, and I'd be in the green again. APSaRA darkened the windows, and a screen popped up displaying my stock. I couldn't do anything with the information, it was all APSaRA controlled, based on my target earnings I had set. The higher the goal, the more risks APSaRA would take with your money, and the more likely you were to lose it all. I was sensible, but it was still a higher than normal target. I had no clue why she showed me my stocks, because it was all Greek to me. "Must be a legal requirement or something," I muttered to myself. I was already at the drive through, and the window rolled down and my food was placed on my table by a robotic arm. I read the day's news. There was too much to make sense of it. APSaRA would give me a summary when I needed it for work.

I felt like something different today. I had a craving for sugarcane juice. I told her to find the closest street vendor. I felt sorry for them. They lived on meagre earnings, and hardly got any business now that the global chains had taken over all food and drink outlets. India and China were the only places in the world where street vendors were still visible in the cities. It was delicious! There's just something about human-hand made food!

With only 15 minutes of my hour long commute remaining, I checked my email. My vehicle insurance premium was auto-paid last night. The occasional horn by one of the few human driven cars left reminded me why I was paying such high premiums. They were ruining it for everyone!

Oh no! My first appointment of the day just emailed to cancel. I adjusted my schedule accordingly. No doubt my boss would find something to fill my time.

When I reached the office, my car immediately zoomed off again. Controlled by APSaRA, making me money

you'd read them all, and that kept me in a job. APSaRA wrote press releases and news items, but articles, reviews and columns were still our forte.

In fact, APSaRA had selected Digit to be the national technology information service, and she translated our content into all languages. We now had a billion plus readers thanks to her!

My boss broke my daydream. "Aren't you supposed to be meeting the Health Minister today?" he asked. I explained that his PA had postponed for the second day in a row. "Third time's the charm!" he said, clearly fond of cliches, and then walked away. He stopped to turn around and remind me and the other writers that he was going to whoop our backsides in Quake VI, and we had no reason to doubt that he would.

I sat and wrote articles all day. It was much easier now that you could just hook up to APSaRA in the interface corner – just place the cranium cap on your head. Start thinking and APSaRA does the rest.

I felt a little uneasy towards the end of the day, and left a little early. APSaRA informed me that I would probably develop a fever tonight as I had some stubborn pathogen in my blood. My doctor had seen my details and the blood test that APSaRA had done without me even knowing, and my medicines would be dispatched via microdrones and waiting for me at home. "Must have been that damn ganna juice," I muttered. No more feeling sorry for anyone.

At home APSaRA played some soothing music, ordered me a hot soup, just the way I liked it, and then set the room temperature absolutely perfectly so that I would be comfortable through the night despite my mild fever. She fussed over me, said "I will handle tomorrow's appointments. I have already informed your boss and your sick leave has been granted. You just rest and recuperate, and tell me what you want for breakfast." I was enjoying the fussing. Maybe the Life Coach mod wasn't that bad after all!

"Goodnight dear," she said softly as I closed my eyes. Just before I fell asleep I mumbled. "Goodnight Apsara. Thank you." 



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as a passenger taxi. I walked into my office to hear a colleague squeal with excitement as he told people about his annual trip home to his village. "It was so nostalgic! I had to press actual physical switches to turn the lights on and off! I would always forget to turn them off when I left the room though, and my parents got a hefty bill. I'm so used to APSaRA, I cannot even imagine how they live without her. Seriously, it's insanely backward!"

The Digit offices were almost the same as they were 25 years ago. Well, apart from the little bots and microdrones that are sent in for review whizzing about. And of course APSaRA and the holographic displays that we work on. Thankfully, humans hated reading AI-written articles. If you'd read one,